

ABILITY

1. Passage anchor

> “She spoke in a calm, confident way, and she had this rare ****ability**** to make difficult ideas sound much less frightening.”

Passage meaning

****ability**** = the power, skill, or capacity to do something successfully

****能力；本領；才能****

Here:

> ****the ability to make difficult ideas sound less frightening****

= ****把困難概念解釋得比較容易理解的能力****

The word emphasizes what Ms. Lau is capable of doing effectively.

Practice

1. She has the ****ability to explain complex ideas clearly****.

她有****清楚解釋複雜概念的能力****。

2. Good teachers need the ****ability to adapt**** when students are confused.

好老師需要具備在學生困惑時****調整方法的能力****。

Core meanings of ABILITY

2. ability — capacity to do something

= the power or skill needed to do something

****能力；本領****

Examples

1. She has the ****ability to solve problems quickly****.

她有****快速解決問題的能力****。

2. His greatest ****ability**** is explaining difficult ideas simply.

他最大的****本領****是把困難的概念解釋得很簡單。

This is the central meaning.

3. ability to do something

= capacity or skill required to perform a particular action

做某事的能力

Examples

1. The job requires the **ability to work under pressure**.

這份工作需要**在壓力下工作的能力**。

2. She showed an impressive **ability to stay calm**.

她展現出令人印象深刻的**保持冷靜的能力**。

This is the exact passage pattern.

Natural or developed talent

4. ability — skill or talent in a particular area

= talent or competence in a specific activity or subject

才能；才幹；能力

Examples

1. She has considerable mathematical **ability**.

她有相當強的數學**能力**。

2. His musical **ability** was obvious from a young age.

他的音樂**才能**從小就很明顯。

5. natural ability

= ability someone seems to possess naturally rather than only through training

天賦；天生能力

Examples

1. She has a **natural ability** for languages.

她有學語言的**天賦**。

2. His **natural ability** helped him learn quickly.
他的**天生能力**幫助他很快學會。

6. artistic / musical / academic ability

= competence or talent in a particular field

藝術 / 音樂 / 學術能力

Examples

1. The student showed strong **academic ability**.
那名學生展現出很強的**學術能力**。
2. Her **artistic ability** developed over time.
她的**藝術才能**逐漸發展起來。

Level of competence

7. ability — level of skill

= how capable someone is at doing something

能力程度 ; 水平

Examples

1. Students of different **abilities** worked together.
不同**能力程度**的學生一起合作。
2. The course is suitable for learners of all **abilities**.
這門課適合各種**程度**的學習者。

Here, plural **abilities** often means different levels or kinds of competence.

8. mixed ability

= involving people with different levels of skill or academic performance

能力混合的 ; 程度不一的

Examples

1. It was a ****mixed-ability class****.

那是一個學生****程度不一的班級****。

2. Teaching a ****mixed-ability group**** requires flexibility.

教一個****能力程度不一的群體****需要彈性。

Very common in education.

9. ability level

= degree of skill or competence someone has

****能力水平；程度****

Examples

1. The tasks were adjusted to each student's ****ability level****.

任務會根據每位學生的****能力水平****調整。

2. Learners were grouped by ****ability level****.

學習者按照****程度****分組。

Mental capacity

10. ability — mental capability

= capacity to understand, think, remember, or reason

****智力能力；認知能力****

Examples

1. The test measures reasoning ****ability****.

這項測驗衡量推理****能力****。

2. Memory ****ability**** varies from person to person.

記憶****能力****因人而異。

11. cognitive ability

= mental capacity involving thinking, memory, attention, reasoning, etc.

****認知能力****

Examples

1. Sleep can affect ****cognitive ability****.
睡眠會影響****認知能力****。
2. The task requires strong ****cognitive abilities****.
這項任務需要很強的****認知能力****。

Physical capability

12. physical ability

= capacity to perform physical actions or activities

****身體能力；體能****

Examples

1. The activity requires good ****physical ability****.
這項活動需要良好的****身體能力****。
2. His ****physical abilities**** improved through training.
他的****體能****透過訓練有所提升。

Legal / formal capacity

13. ability — capacity to meet an obligation

= practical or financial capacity to do something

****能力；履行能力****

Examples

1. The court considered his ****ability to pay****.
法院考慮了他的****付款能力****。
2. Their ****ability to meet the deadline**** was uncertain.
他們能否按時完成的****能力****仍不確定。

This is more formal and practical.

14. ability to pay

= financial capacity to pay a cost, debt, fee, or tax

支付能力；付款能力

Examples

1. Fees may depend on **ability to pay**.
費用可能取決於**支付能力**。
2. The policy considers each person's **ability to pay**.
這項政策會考慮每個人的**付款能力**。

Institutional / system capability

15. ability — capability of a system or organization

= what a machine, system, organization, or process is capable of doing

能力；功能

Examples

1. The system has the **ability to detect errors automatically**.
這個系統具有**自動偵測錯誤的能力**。
2. The organization's **ability to respond quickly** improved.
這個組織的**快速應變能力**有所提升。

This extends beyond human beings.

High-value expressions

16. have the ability to...

= possess the necessary capacity or skill to do something

具備做.....的能力

Examples

1. She **has the ability to remain calm under pressure**.

她**具備在壓力下保持冷靜的能力**。

2. Good leaders **have the ability to listen carefully**.
好的領導者**有仔細聆聽的能力**。

17. show / demonstrate ability

= reveal skill or competence through performance
展現能力

Examples

1. She **demonstrated great ability** as a teacher.
她展現出很強的教學**能力**。
2. The student **showed strong analytical ability**.
那名學生展現出很強的分析**能力**。

18. develop ability

= improve or build skill over time
培養能力；提升能力

Examples

1. Practice helps students **develop their ability to communicate**.
練習有助學生**培養溝通能力**。
2. The course is designed to **develop problem-solving ability**.
這門課旨在**培養解決問題的能力**。

19. lose the ability to...

= no longer be capable of doing something
失去做.....的能力

Examples

1. He temporarily **lost the ability to speak clearly**.
他一度**失去清楚說話的能力**。

2. The machine **lost the ability to connect to the network**.

那台機器**失去了連接網路的功能**。

20. beyond someone's ability

= too difficult for someone's current level of skill or competence

超出某人的能力範圍

Examples

1. The task was **beyond my ability** at the time.

那項任務當時**超出了我的能力範圍**。

2. The problem is not **beyond her ability**.

這個問題並沒有**超出她的能力**。

Word family

21. able

= having the ability, skill, or opportunity to do something

能夠的；有能力的

Examples

1. She is **able to explain difficult ideas clearly**.

她**能夠清楚解釋困難概念**。

2. I wasn't **able to answer the question**.

我**沒能回答那個問題**。

22. be able to

= have the capacity or opportunity to do something

能夠；可以

Examples

1. She was **able to calm the whole class**.

她**能夠讓全班冷靜下來**。

2. Will you be **able to finish today**?

你今天**能完成嗎**？

23. unable

= not able to do something

不能的；無法.....的

Examples

1. He was **unable to explain the result**.

他**無法解釋這個結果**。

2. She felt **unable to speak**.

她覺得自己**說不出話來**。

24. inability

= lack of ability to do something

無能力；無法做到

Examples

1. His **inability to adapt** caused problems.

他**缺乏適應能力**造成了問題。

2. The delay resulted from their **inability to communicate clearly**.

延誤源自他們**無法清楚溝通**。

25. disability

Historically related to **ability**, but now a distinct and important lexical item.

= physical, sensory, intellectual, developmental, or other impairment that may interact with barriers and affect participation

身心障礙；障礙

This term should not simply be interpreted as “lack of ability.”

Because it has its own established modern meanings and usage conventions, it deserves separate treatment if needed.

Countability

26. ability can be countable or uncountable

Uncountable/general

> She has great **ability**.

> 她很有**能力**。

Countable/specific skills

> She has many different **abilities**.

> 她有很多不同的**能力**。

Examples

1. His natural **ability** impressed the teacher.

他的天生**能力**令老師印象深刻。

2. The role requires several different **abilities**.

這個職位需要幾種不同的**能力**。

Key contrasts

27. ability vs skill

ability

= general capacity to do something, whether natural or developed

能力

skill

= learned proficiency developed through practice

技能 ; 技巧

Compare:

> She has the **ability** to explain clearly.

> 她有清楚解釋的能力。

- > Clear explanation is an important teaching **skill**.
- > 清楚解釋是一項重要的教學技能。

A skill is a type of ability, but **ability** is broader.

28. ability vs talent

talent

= natural aptitude, especially in a particular area

天分；才華

ability

= natural or learned capacity

能力

Compare:

- > She has a natural **talent for music**.
- > 她有音樂天分。
- > She developed the **ability to perform confidently**.
- > 她培養出有自信表演的能力。

29. ability vs capacity

capacity

= potential or maximum capability to do, hold, understand, or produce something

能力；容量；承受力

ability

= competence to perform a particular action

Compare:

- > the **ability to solve problems**
- > 解決問題的能力
- > the **capacity to learn from experience**
- > 從經驗中學習的能力 / 潛力

They overlap strongly in abstract use.

30. ability vs capability

****capability****

= ability or potential to perform a function, often used for systems, organizations, or broader competencies

****能力；功能；潛能****

****ability****

is more common for individual human competence.

Compare:

> her ****ability to teach****

> 她的教學能力

> the system's processing ****capability****

> 系統的處理能力

31. ability vs competence

****competence****

= sufficient or recognized ability to perform something to an acceptable standard

****勝任能力；能力****

****ability****

does not necessarily imply a formal standard.

Compare:

> She has excellent language ****ability****.

> 她的語言能力很好。

> The assessment tests professional ****competence****.

> 這項評估測試專業勝任能力。

32. ability vs intelligence

****intelligence****

= mental ability involving understanding, reasoning, learning, and judgment

****智力 ; 智慧****

****ability****

= much broader; can be mental, physical, social, technical, artistic, etc.

Compare:

> emotional ****intelligence****

> 情緒智慧

> communication ****ability****

> 溝通能力

33. ability vs knowledge

****knowledge****

= information and understanding someone possesses

****知識****

****ability****

= capacity to use skills or perform actions

****能力****

A person may know what should be done without having the ability to do it well.

Meaning map

The central concept of ****ability**** is:

****capacity to do something successfully****

From this develop:

General competence

ability to explain

→ ****解釋能力****

Talent

musical ability

→ ****音樂才能****

Level

students of different abilities

→ **不同能力程度**

Mental

cognitive ability

→ **認知能力**

Physical

physical ability

→ **身體能力**

Financial/practical

ability to pay

→ **支付能力**

System

ability to detect errors

→ **系統功能 / 能力**

The passage uses the general skill/capacity branch:

****Ms. Lau can consistently perform a difficult teaching task well.****

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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ability — general capacity	能成功完成某件事的能力、本領或才幹
ability to do something	完成某個特定行動所需要的能力
ability — talent/skill	在某個領域表現出的才能或熟練能力
natural ability	不完全依靠後天訓練而具有的天賦 / 天生能力
academic/artistic/musical ability	在特定學術、藝術或音樂領域的能力 / 才華
ability — level of competence	某人的能力程度或技能水平
mixed ability	一群人之中成員能力 / 程度不同
ability level	某人在某技能或學科上的能力水平
cognitive ability	思考、理解、記憶、注意與推理等認知能力
physical ability	完成身體活動所需的身體能力 / 體能

ability to pay	支付費用、債務或其他金額的財務能力	
system/organizational ability	系統或組織執行某功能、反應或完成工作的能力	
have the ability to...	具備做某件事所需的能力	
show/demonstrate ability	透過表現展現某項能力	
develop ability	透過學習、練習等逐步培養能力	
lose the ability to...	不再具備完成某動作的能力	
beyond someone's ability	超出某人目前能完成或處理的能力範圍	
able	具有做某事能力的；能夠	
be able to	有能力或條件完成某事；能夠	
unable	沒有能力或無法做某事	
inability	缺乏做某件事的能力；無法做到	

Passage recap

> “...she had this rare ****ability**** to make difficult ideas sound much less frightening.”

Here:

****ability**** = ****the skill or capacity to do something successfully****

Best Traditional Chinese:

* ****能力****

* ****本領****

* ****才能****

Natural contextual translation:

****她有一種很難得的能力，就是能把困難的概念講得沒那麼可怕。****

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

****ability****

= ****the capacity or skill to do something successfully****

****能力；本領；才能****

The passage specifically uses the pattern:

> ****ability to + verb****

so:

> ****the ability to make difficult ideas easier to understand****

= ****把困難概念講得容易理解的能力****

The most useful contrast is:

* ****ability**** → broad capacity

* ****skill**** → learned proficiency

* ****talent**** → especially natural aptitude

In this passage, ****ability**** is the broadest and most natural choice.